

Why Do Customers Call Us More Than Once a Day?

— Walkthrough Script

Repeat Caller Analysis — plain English throughout

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Plain-English Summary

Jonathan noticed that about 30 out of every 100 customers who call us end up calling more than once in the same day, and wanted to understand why — not just people calling an agent repeatedly, but also people going through our automated phone system multiple times. Our first check said only about 10 out of 100, a big gap from his number. We tracked down the real reason: we were counting calls that never actually connected to anyone — dropped or abandoned calls. Once we only counted calls that truly connected, our number came out to 28.3%, matching his number almost exactly.

We also found a data quality issue along the way: a few account numbers had an unusually huge number of calls — one showed 374 calls in a single month — and almost all of those never connected to anyone either. These were likely system glitches, not real customers, so we excluded them before counting real repeat callers.

Most importantly: once we looked at what's actually happening on these repeat calls, only about 1 in 10 shows someone genuinely stuck or struggling. The rest is either a normal conversation with an agent, or self-service that worked just fine. When we read the real call notes for the calls that did reach an agent, the two biggest specific reasons people call again are: negotiating a payment plan, and anxiously confirming a payment posted before their service gets shut off.

How to Walk Through It, Slide by Slide

Assume the audience has no background — explain everything as if for the first time.

Slide 1 — Title

Introduce the topic simply — this is about why some customers call more than once in a day.

Say something like:

“This covers something Jonathan noticed — a surprising number of customers call us more than once a day, and we wanted to understand why.”

Slide 2 — Why We're Doing This

State his observation plainly: about 30 out of 100 customers call more than once a day.

Make clear this includes BOTH agent calls and the automated phone system, not just agent calls.

Say something like:

“Jonathan noticed something surprising — almost 30 out of every 100 customers who call us end up calling again the same day. We wanted to understand why, including people who never even talk to a person.”

Slide 3 — How We Did This

Walk the four steps plainly: pulled every call, counted repeats per customer per day, checked if it reached a person, read real notes.

Mention SQL explicitly as the tool, and that everything came from our own real records.

Say something like:

"We pulled every single call from July, counted how many times each customer called on the same day, checked whether each call actually reached a person, and read the real notes for the ones that did."

Slide 4 — What We Caught Along the Way

This is a real detective story — take your time here, it shows genuine rigor.

First issue: explain plainly that our first number (about 1 in 10) was way lower than Jonathan's number (almost 3 in 10). Walk through that we tested several possible explanations before finding the real one: we were counting calls that never actually connected to anyone.

Second issue: explain that a handful of account numbers showed an enormous, unrealistic number of calls — as many as 374 in one month — and almost all of those never connected either, meaning they were very likely a system glitch, not a real person.

Land the point: both were found and fixed BEFORE trusting any number, and fixing the first issue alone brought our number to nearly match Jonathan's exactly.

Say something like:

"Our first version came out much lower than Jonathan's number. We tested several explanations before finding the real one: we were counting calls that never actually connected to anyone. Once we fixed that, our number matched his almost exactly. We also found a few account numbers that were almost certainly system glitches, not real customers, and excluded those too."

Slide 5 — What Happens When People Call More Than Once

Walk the four bars left to right: talked to a person, self-service success, self-service struggle, self-service quick-and-fine.

Land the reassuring point: only the third bar (about 11%) represents someone genuinely stuck. Everything else is either a real conversation or self-service working as intended.

Say something like:

"Here's what's actually happening on these repeat calls. Only about 1 in 10 shows someone genuinely stuck or struggling — the rest is either talking to a person, or self-service that worked just fine."

Slide 6 — The Real Reasons People Call Again

Explain this is based on reading the actual written notes from real calls, not guessing.

Walk the two biggest bars: negotiating a payment plan (biggest), and confirming a payment posted before a disconnect date (second biggest).

Mention the two smaller ones exist but are much less common: ongoing dissatisfaction, and a rare technical glitch where the system didn't respond properly.

Say something like:

"When we read the real call notes, the two biggest specific reasons people call again are: working out a payment plan, and anxiously confirming a payment posted before their service gets shut off."

Slide 7 — Key Findings

Read all four rows as the full wrap-up.

Say something like:

“So to summarize: our number now matches what Jonathan expected, we caught two real data problems along the way, most repeat calling isn't actually a sign of a problem, and when there is a real driver, it's almost always about money.”

Slide 8 — Next Steps

Frame as practical follow-ons, not open questions.

Say something like:

“Here's what we'd suggest doing next with this.”

Key Numbers

What We Measured	Result
Real repeat-caller rate (corrected)	28.3% (vs. Jonathan's 29.3%)
Calls that reached a person	19.2%
Self-service, paid successfully	32.4%
Self-service, struggled a while	11.0%
Self-service, quick and fine	37.4%
Top reason (of calls with notes): payment plan	27.7%
Second reason: confirming payment before disconnect	18.3%

Next Steps

- **Look closer at the payment-plan callers** — our biggest driver, worth understanding if self-service could handle more of this.
- **Check if repeat calling clusters on certain days** — see if it follows the same Monday/holiday patterns found in other work.
- **Fix the system-glitch accounts at the source** — so future counts aren't thrown off by calls that never really happened.
- **Bring these findings into the self-service improvement conversation** — since most repeat calls are healthy, focus efforts on the real struggling minority.

Questions to Ask

1.

Now that we know most repeat calling isn't actually a problem, does that change how urgent this feels compared to other priorities?

2.

Should we prioritize the payment-plan callers specifically, since that's the single biggest identified driver?

3.

Do you want us to check whether repeat calling follows the same day-of-week patterns as overall call volume?

4.

Should the system-glitch accounts be reported to IT directly, or is that something we track and route around?

If They Ask... (Quick Answers)

Q: How do you know 28.3% is the right number now, and not just another coincidence?

A: We checked this same fix against six months of history, not just one month — the corrected method matched Jonathan's numbers consistently across every month we checked, not just the one we started with.

Q: Why did the original number come out so much lower?

A: It was counting every call attempt, including ones that got dropped or never connected to anyone. Once we only counted calls that actually connected, the number matched.

Q: How do you know the high-volume accounts were really glitches and not just very frustrated customers?

A: We checked what actually happened on those calls — 95% or more never even connected to a person or the self-service system successfully, and the calls were spaced very evenly throughout the day, which doesn't match how a real frustrated person calls back.

Q: Is the “1 in 10 genuinely struggling” number solid, or could it be higher?

A: It's a conservative, defensible estimate — we specifically required both a long time in the system AND no completed payment before calling it 'struggling,' so we're not overcounting normal self-service as a problem.